PassFrame
TUITION

The Deepest Place on Earth

Year 4 — 11+ Lesson Worksheet (PassFrame Tuition)

Comprehension | Non-fiction (Science)

Extract — read it carefully before answering

Far beneath the surface of the Pacific Ocean lies a place so deep and so dark that sunlight has never once reached it. This is the Mariana Trench, and at its deepest point — known as Challenger Deep — the seabed sits almost eleven kilometres below the waves.

To understand just how deep that is, imagine stacking Mount Everest, the tallest mountain on Earth, on top of itself inside the trench. Even then, there would still be more than two kilometres of water left above its peak.

The pressure at the bottom of the Mariana Trench is extraordinary — more than a thousand times greater than at sea level. For many years, scientists believed nothing could possibly survive down there, crushed under such enormous weight.

They were wrong. Strange, pale creatures have been discovered thriving in the crushing darkness, including a type of shrimp-like animal and even microscopic organisms that seem perfectly at home in conditions that would instantly destroy a human body.

Only a handful of people have ever travelled to the very bottom of the trench, in specially built submarines strong enough to withstand the pressure. Even today, we know more about the surface of the Moon than we do about this hidden world at the bottom of our own ocean.

Questions

20 min · 12 questions

1. What is the name of the deepest place on Earth described in this extract?

2. How deep is Challenger Deep, according to the text?

3. Underline the sentence that tells you sunlight never reaches this part of the ocean.

4. Underline the sentence that uses Mount Everest to help explain the trench's depth.

5. What does “extraordinary” mean as it is used to describe the pressure?

6. True or false: scientists originally believed nothing could survive in the trench.

7. Why do you think the author compares the trench's depth to stacking Mount Everest inside it?

8. What two types of creature does the text say have been found living in the trench?

9. In your own words, explain why so few people have travelled to the bottom of the trench.

10. What does the comparison to the Moon at the end of the extract suggest about how much we know about the trench?

11. Why might the author have chosen to end the extract with a comparison to outer space?

12. Do you find it surprising that creatures can survive in the trench? Explain your thinking using evidence from the text.